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How to pass password to scp command used in bash script? [duplicate]

Asked 11 years, 8 months ago Modified 9 years, 10 months ago Viewed 706k times



62



This question already has answers here:

Closed 10 years ago.

Possible Duplicate:

[Connect through SSH and type in password automatically, without using a public key.](#)

I have a bash script that makes dump of DB then copies file from one server to another but it always asks for password before connection.

```
scp file.tar.gz root@xxx.xxx.xxx.194:/backup
```

Is there a way to pass password directly into script ?

bash

password

scp

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edited Apr 13, 2017 at 12:14



Community Bot
1

asked Oct 4, 2011 at 19:59



chubbyk

883 ● 2 ● 10 ● 15

2 [how2s.org/index.php/...](#) – mailq Oct 4, 2011 at 20:05

1 Also, [answered on StackOverflow](#) – glenn jackman Oct 4, 2011 at 20:18

1 [serverfault.com/questions/132405/...](#) – quanta Oct 5, 2011 at 2:22

5 This is something I really hate about many online communities; They will tell you that you are doing something stupid and then not give you the answer. – Mr. Developerdude Sep 21, 2014 at 23:33

Sorted by:

6 Answers

Highest score (default) Use the tool [sshpas](#)

95

```
sshpas -p 'password' scp file.tar.gz root@xxx.xxx.xxx.194:/backup
```



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answered Aug 2, 2012 at 13:52



GGarciaBas

951 ● 6 ● 2



- 14 This is not a standard part of OpenSSH, and literally none of my machines (Mac OS X 10.7, Ubuntu 12.04, FreeBSD 8, Debian 3.1) have it. It's also the accepted answer provided on the question that this one is marked as a duplicate of... – [voretaq7](#) Aug 2, 2012 at 14:57 
- 6 Excellent! Security isn't always a concern, such as during cross-platform development of a box within the firewall. On systems with apt-get, install with `sudo apt-get install -y sshpass` – [Brent Faust](#) Oct 17, 2013 at 1:15 
- 6 OK, to add extra security, consider `sshpas -f file_with_password`. Then secure the password file's permissions, make it work, and then read some "clever" advice about how using sshpass is bad, and authorized_keys is great. Especially, when somebody else just gives you login+pass (e.g. for SFTP), and no option to authorize your public key... – [Tomasz Gandor](#) Oct 21, 2014 at 6:04 
- 3 I recommend reading the password from prompt once with `read -s -p "Enter ssh password : " PASSWORD_SSH;` and then use that in the sshpass phrase `sshpas -p $PASSWORD_SSH scp file.tar.gz root@xxx.xxx.xxx.194:/backup` – [yunzen](#) Apr 14, 2015 at 7:29



Rather than using root create an account just for this job. Use public keys without a passphrase instead of passwords.

45

```
scp -i /home/backupuser/.ssh/id_rsa backupuser@xxx.xxx.xxx.194:/backup
```



By using a special account for the backup on the destination system you are not exposing your root password.



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answered Oct 4, 2011 at 20:10



user9517

115k ● 20 ● 211 ● 294

- 3 +1 for referring a creation of a specific account for file uploads instead of using root. And I will also recommend using a restricted shell like `rssh` for this user. – [noisebleed](#) Jul 26, 2012 at 12:38
- 15 -1 for not answering the question. – [Eric Uldall](#) Oct 18, 2014 at 0:26
- 1 +nitpick for recommending another solution to the posed problem even though it does not literally answer the question. – [Mantriur](#) Jun 6, 2016 at 20:26



It's better to set up ssh to used key-based authentication rather than trying to figure out how to send text to the login process with something like `expect`.

4

Take a look at:



<https://help.ubuntu.com/community/SSH/OpenSSH/Keys>



So, basically, run `ssh-keygen -t dsa` on the machine that will run your script. When it asks you for a passphrase, hit ENTER to accept a blank. You will get two files. If you followed the default suggestions, the files will be `~/.ssh/id_dsa` and `~/.ssh/id_dsa.pub`. The first one is the private key. The second one is the public key.

Copy the public key to the second server using `ssh-copy-id user@server2`. This will add the public key to the `authorized_keys` file of the user on server2.

You should now be able to run ssh from the first machine and log in without a password.

For copying the files, scp or rsync are fine. It depends on what you're doing. rsync will use ssh by default, so will use the key-based authentication you just set up.

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answered Mar 23, 2012 at 10:50



cjc

24.8k

3

50

70



`scp` uses `SSH` to tunnel to a remote server and transfer files. `SSH` can authenticate users with a password, an `SSH` key or both (recommended).

3



To transfer files without a password, [create an SSH key](#) for the user you're going to use (root is *not* recommended, use an unprivileged user instead and have a job on the target server as root to perform the privileged action).



Then you need to configure the target system's `SSH` daemon to accept `SSH` key connections (also in above link).

Bear in mind that compromised `SSH` keys without a password are the same as compromised passwords - anybody can get in. For real users, it's better to double the security and require the key and a password.

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answered Oct 4, 2011 at 20:09



Andy

5,220 ● 1 ● 24 ● 34

▲
3 [pscp](#) allows you to pass the password to it directly using the `-pw` argument. Alternately, and this is a better idea, use ssh agent and set up key based login - this is more secure. There's a howto on setting up ssh to use key based [login](#) here

▼ You can use the [yes](#) command to send a yes to the program.

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edited Aug 8, 2013 at 3:08



Community Bot

1



Journeyman Geek

6,997 ● 3 ● 32 ● 50

this was a great fix to the problem of getting ssh keys onto 16 vms, most answer just say 'use keys' leading to having to manually login to each server to add a key when we need to set them up in large groups. Running this on bash on windows looks like `PSCP.EXE -l $username -pw $password localflie "$HOST:/tmp/remotefile"` – [simbo1905](#) Jun 13, 2019 at 13:40 ✎

▲ You should **not use** password-less ssh-keys for security reasons.

2

▼ The tool [keychain](#) can help you re-use the ssh-agent and run rsync over ssh in scripts without being prompted for passwords.

To install it on a Ubuntu machine just run the following command.



```
sudo apt-get install keychain
```

Check out the [manpage for keychain](#) for more information on how to use it.

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answered Mar 23, 2012 at 11:02



pkhamre

6,110 ● 3 ● 17 ● 27